

1. Purpose

To provide recommendations regarding the creation of emergency access accounts.

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3. Reference

3.1. Purpose

The emergency access (or break glass) account is intended to provide a means of last resort to access a tenant. This account should not be used except in an emergency.

The account must be a global administrator in the tenant's Azure AD and must be exempted from conditional access policies..

IMPORTANT: Should a customer become completely locked out, including the reseller and TD SYNnex, the only option to regain access is for the end user's global administrator to contact the Microsoft Data Protection Team directly. Per Microsoft's rules, the reseller and TD SYNnex is not able to assist in case. The customer will need to contact the Microsoft hotline by using the local number and the support team there will create a Service Request ticket for them. [Contact Microsoft Office Support - Microsoft Support](#)

3.2. Suggestions

The account...

- should be verified that it has the correct access after creation;
- must be exempted from all conditional access policies;
- should use a non-phone-based MFA solution; and,
- must have a password
 - using upper & lower case letters, numbers, and special characters;
 - be at least 12 characters long (16 characters recommended);
 - not contain any words;
 - not contain word using substitution characters such as \$ for s;

Also,

- Do not store the password online. Store it in a sealed envelope in a safe;
- Do not have browsers store the credentials;
- Change the password after each use;

Emergency Access Accounts



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- Do not provide the account an email address; and,
- Use a SIEM solution to monitor and alert on any use.

3.3. MFA Mandate

Starting on October 15, 2024, [Microsoft mandated](#) the use of MFA by accounts accessing management portals. This mandate applies to Emergency Access Accounts.

Microsoft recommend using FIDO2 or certificates with Emergency Access Accounts.

4. Associated Documents

- [Manage emergency access admin accounts - Microsoft Entra | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Secure access practices for administrators in Azure AD - Microsoft Entra | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Create Emergency Access Accounts for AAD and Use Log Analytics to Monitor Sign-ins from them \(microsoft.com\)](#)
- [Create and use strong passwords - Microsoft Support](#)
- [azure-docs/security-emergency-access.md at main · MicrosoftDocs/azure-docs · GitHub](#)
- [Contact Microsoft Office Support - Microsoft Support](#)
- [Mandatory Microsoft Entra multifactor authentication \(MFA\) - Microsoft Entra ID | Microsoft Learn](#)

5. Document Approval

This document has been approved by:

- Manager, Cloud Sales Engineering

6. Document Revision History

Number	Effective Date	Revision History	Author
1.0	4/4/2023	Initial Draft	David Bloom
1.1	7/9/2024	Added note about lockout	David Bloom
2.0	9/25/2024	Revised for MFA mandate	David Bloom